MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 4-17-2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
March 20, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Samantha Pitchford, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the agenda with one addition, **motion carried**

*addition
Under Public Hearings/Special Presentation
Add New Dawn Shelter

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of February 21, 2024, **motion carried**.

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Committee of the Whole Minutes of March 6, 2024, **motion carried**.

It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Closed Session Board of Commissioners Minutes of March 6, 2024, with one addition, **motion carried**.

*addition – to add that Attorney for Courts appeared via zoom.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Brian Coon thanked the Board of Commissioners for their letter of support regarding funding for a new Road Commission building.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Resolution, Washtenaw County supporting state wide water affordability legislation - No discussion

2. Resolution, Washtenaw County supporting to repeal preventing local ordinances to ban plastic bags – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with updates regarding the different house bills that are in the Legislature. She confirmed that she did not put the upcoming millage renewals on the agenda because of a tax amount change and will not have the figures until April.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Marlana Terrian, E/911 Director
   Director Terrian was present to give the Board of Commissioners an overview of Emergency 9-1-1 and Dispatch. She went over the governance & history, revenue streams, staffing (8 employees), duties and responsibilities, challenges and upcoming projects.

2. Karl Hauser, Veterans Director
   Director Hauser presented the annual report for Veterans Services, which includes the different types of claims they help veterans with, an overview of the financial impact to Clare County and the different types of assistance they provide veterans. Director Hauser went into detail regarding the services provided to veterans from the Soldier's Relief Fund, Michigan Veterans Trust Fund and burial allowance. Director Hauser confirmed that Clare County also has a Veteran's Treatment Court and explained the different community outreach programs they participate in and the Veteran's Crisis Line.

   Allisha Gary, assistant to the Veteran's Director gave a report regarding the veteran's transportation network in which they transported 275 veterans in 2023 and the donations for basket items that are handed out to local veterans.

3. New Dawn Shelter
   Doug Lewis, Co-Director of New Dawn Shelter and Lanette Morgan were present to explain the New Dawn Shelter that is available to Clare County residents. Director Lewis explained the homeless shelter's mission, case management and funding, which is faith based and does not qualify for state funding (they are funded by donations only). New Dawn Shelter has limited the scope of services to Gladwin, Clare and Arenac Counties and are based out of Gladwin County. The New Dawn Shelter performs a pretty extensive criminal background check and require the participants to participate in case management and treatment programs if necessary. The core philosophy is to offer a hand up and not a hand out. New Dawn Shelter works with Community Mental Health, Mid-Michigan Community Action Agency, Department of Health and Human Services and the court system. The shelter is volunteer driven and they are very careful to protect guests and staff. Director Lewis confirmed that almost half of people in their shelter come from Clare County.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

1. It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the MSHNN Substance Use Disorder Oversight Policy Advisory Board Intergovernmental Agreement, **motion carried**.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of February 20, 2024 in the amount of $169,519.15 and the meeting minutes of March 4, 2024 in the amount of $170,836.44, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Majewski, Pitchford, Fancon, Kleinhardt and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Pitchford, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the expenditures for the month of February 2024, in the amount of $3,602,151.13 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,111,011.08, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Pitchford, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Fancon, Gilmore, Housler, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

3. Sale of Property
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to allow the County Administrator to list and sell the Clare County owned property in Redding Township, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Housler, Pitchford and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott gave an update regarding early voting. Clerk Mott reported that voters utilized the early voting location for all 18 jurisdictions located in Clare County. Clerk Mott outlined some of the ways she saved Clare County $75,265.00 during early voting (early voting equipment support $18,000.00, programming the ballot $23,265.00 and early voting notification postcards $34,000.00).

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners and the following updates

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger and her staff are working on delinquent tax settlement of 2023 taxes. They reconciled a little over $53 million in expected revenues of which approximately $5.4 million or 10% are delinquent. They currently have three years of active delinquent taxes in her office. The 2023's mentioned above. The 2022 delinquent taxes just went into forfeiture meaning they are over one year delinquent. There were approximately 1100 properties that went into forfeiture that will be sent to the Register of Deeds office to be recorded.

TREASURER'S REPORT - continued

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger confirmed that the 2021 taxes are in danger of foreclosure, approximately 169 at this time. Most of these will be paid by the end of the month.

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger and her staff is working very hard to help our taxpayers, of the $5.4 million delinquent 2023 taxes, they have already collected $350,000.00.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Jeff Haskell confirmed that Clare County unemployment is at 6.2% and he has been attending his meetings.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Dale Majewski has been attending his meetings and congratulated Greenwood Township on their 150 year anniversary on April 6, 2024

Vice Chairman Majewski updated the Board of Commissioners on the ambulance service meeting – MMR ran the meeting, they reviewed operations, broke down types of calls they have and identified problems. The next move is for MMR to collect data and have another meeting regarding issues and problems, it was well run by MMR.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings – no report

Commissioner Hoefling reported regarding bids and new leases for the Airport Committee, Hamilton Township is working on changes to their master plan, Winterfield Township approved a spill or pay ordinance and Frost Township added a new credit card policy.

Commissioner Pitchford has attended her meetings – no report

Commissioner Ambrozaitis thanked the Board of Commissioners for the letter of support for the Road Commission and shared a thank you from Hayes Township for the consolidated early voting.

Commissioner Gilmore attending meetings – no report. Commissioner Gilmore then reported about a constituent complaint regarding an animal control ticket and the difficulty in paying the ticket. Commissioner Gilmore questioned Prosecutor Ambrozaitis regarding the process. Prosecutor Ambrozaitis confirmed the process is outlined on the back of the ticket.

Commissioner Kleinhardt commented on solar cells and the big activity in Sheridan Township and Arthur Township.

Commissioner Fancon had no report but thanked Administrator Phelps for the healthy budget and cautioned the Board of Commissioners on the need to stay diligent regarding the budget.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported that she will continue to monitor the budget and report any progress or issues. She is planning for increase in retirement of $200,000 per year for the next five years. Administrator Phelps will be bringing information each month beginning in April regarding the budget. She is very concerned about the 2024-2025 budget. She confirmed that everyone is working together to save money and watching costs. She is working on union negotiations, Headlee Rollback, 7.5% health insurance increase and retirement increase.

PUBLIC COMMENT

Bill Simpson has petitions if anyone wants to sign regarding amending the clean and renewable energy and energy waste reduction act in certain wind, solar and energy storage.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 10:58 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners